

Failure of Bell Factorization from Non-Injective Effective Descriptions

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Abstract

Violations of Bell inequalities are commonly interpreted as evidence for nonlocal influences or as constraints on realist descriptions. We show that the failure of Bell-type factorizability arises generically whenever observable outcomes are obtained through a non-injective mapping from an underlying configuration space. In this setting, probabilistic factorization fails not because of superluminal dynamics but due to structural information loss under projection. The framework preserves locality at the underlying level, requires no hidden-variable dynamics, and does not modify quantum mechanics. We identify a minimal structural condition for Bell violations and clarify the regime in which classical factorizability is recovered when the effective mapping becomes approximately injective.

Keywords: Bell inequalities; quantum correlations; non-injective projection; probabilistic factorization; locality; quantum foundations

1. Introduction

The experimental violation of Bell inequalities stands as one of the most robust and conceptually challenging features of quantum theory. Repeated tests have confirmed that correlations observed between spacelike separated measurement outcomes cannot be reproduced by any local hidden-variable model satisfying statistical factorization. This empirical fact is commonly interpreted as requiring either nonlocal dynamics, the abandonment of realism, or more radical departures from classical causal intuition.

Despite these conclusions, it is important to recall that Bell inequalities do not constrain physical dynamics directly. They constrain the logical and probabilistic structure of effective descriptions, specifically the assumption that joint outcome probabilities factorize into independent local contributions conditioned on a complete specification of relevant variables. The failure of Bell inequalities therefore indicates a breakdown of effective factorization, but does not, by itself, mandate superluminal influences or causal nonlocality.

In this work, we explore a general and minimal mechanism by which Bell-type correlations may arise without invoking nonlocal dynamics, retrocausality, or hidden variables. The central observation is that effective physical descriptions often arise through many-to-one mappings from underlying configurations to observable outcomes. When this mapping is non-injective, distinct underlying configurations correspond to the same observable description, leading generically to a loss of factorization at the level of observable probabilities.

The non-injective mapping considered here should not be understood as a purely abstract probabilistic construction. Rather, it reflects a structural projection from an underlying relational configuration space to an effective four-dimensional spacetime description

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in which observations are defined. Observable events correspond not to individual microscopic configurations, but to equivalence classes of underlying states that cannot be distinguished within the effective description.

We study a class of effective models in which observable outcomes are obtained through such non-injective projections from an underlying configuration space. The underlying description is assumed to be local and deterministic, but is not fully recoverable from observables due to the many-to-one nature of the projection. As a result, joint probabilities of outcomes do not admit a factorized representation, even though no superluminal interaction or exchange of information occurs. The violation of Bell inequalities is thus traced to a structural property of the descriptive mapping itself, rather than to any dynamical nonlocality.

The effective loss of information associated with this projection is not arbitrary. In physical realizations, it is naturally controlled by Planck's constant h , which sets the minimal resolution at which distinct underlying configurations can be operationally distinguished. Quantum states therefore correspond to equivalence classes whose typical size is determined by h , rather than to sharply defined microscopic configurations. The breakdown of factorization reflects this irreducible coarse-graining, not an epistemic lack of knowledge.

Within this framework, quantum correlations are understood as manifestations of global descriptive consistency. Spacelike separated measurements correspond to different local realizations compatible with a single non-factorizable effective description, rather than to independent subsystems endowed with pre-existing local properties. The assumption of outcome determinism conditioned on local variables fails, not because of hidden influences, but because no complete set of outcome-defining variables exists at the effective level.

This perspective naturally accounts for the emergence of classical behavior. In regimes where environmental interactions, coarse-graining, or loss of resolution render the effective mapping approximately injective, observable descriptions become effectively factorizable and Bell violations are suppressed. Classical statistical independence thus appears as a limiting case of effective injectivity, rather than as a fundamental principle.

The scope of the present work is deliberately restricted. We do not propose a modification of quantum dynamics, introduce additional physical degrees of freedom, or advance a specific underlying dynamical model. Our analysis is structural in nature and concerns the logical conditions under which Bell-type inequalities apply to effective descriptions. By isolating non-injective projection as a sufficient mechanism for the failure of factorization, we aim to clarify the conceptual origin of quantum correlations while preserving both operational locality and the empirical content of quantum theory.

The non-injective projection considered here is not introduced ad hoc, but arises naturally in a relational framework where spacetime and observables emerge as effective descriptions from an underlying configuration space, developed in [1].

2. Non-Injective Projection and the Failure of Bell Factorization

We consider a minimal abstract setting in which observable descriptions arise from an underlying configuration space through a generally many-to-one mapping. Let Ω denote the space of underlying configurations, assumed to be fully specified and governed by local dynamics. Observable outcomes are defined through a projection

$$\Pi : \Omega \rightarrow \mathcal{O}, \quad (1)$$

where $\mathcal{O}$ is the space of observable states or measurement outcomes. Crucially, Π is assumed to be non-injective, so that multiple distinct elements of Ω correspond to the same observable description.

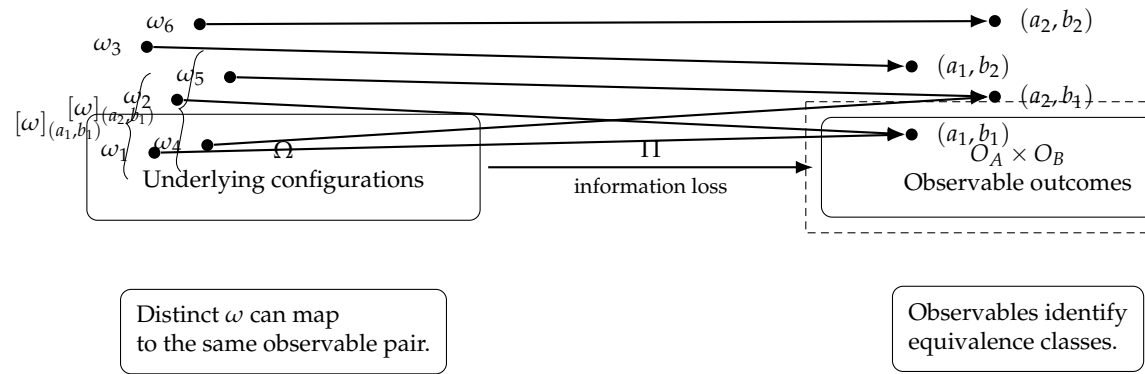


Figure 1. Schematic non-injective projection from the underlying configuration space Ω to the observable outcome space $O_A \times O_B$. Multiple underlying configurations correspond to the same observable pair (a, b) , defining equivalence classes. This many-to-one identification induces a generic failure of probabilistic factorization at the observable level without requiring nonlocal dynamics.

Here Ω denotes an underlying configuration space from which effective observables arise through projection. Such configuration spaces appear in various approaches where observable descriptions are obtained through coarse-graining of a more detailed state space. Examples of such configuration spaces arise in relational or spectral reconstruction approaches [1]. This configuration space should not be interpreted as a hidden physical state space or as an ontological completion of quantum mechanics, but rather as a structural space of admissible relational configurations underlying the effective description.

Figure 1 provides a schematic illustration of this many-to-one projection mechanism. A concrete toy model making this structure explicit is presented in Appendix B.

Let A and B denote two spacelike separated measurement settings, with corresponding observable outcomes $a \in \mathcal{O}_A$ and $b \in \mathcal{O}_B$. In standard local hidden-variable models, one assumes the existence of a variable λ such that the joint probability distribution factorizes as

$$P(a, b \mid A, B, \lambda) = P(a \mid A, \lambda) P(b \mid B, \lambda). \quad (2)$$

Bell inequalities follow from this factorization together with statistical independence assumptions on λ .

In the present framework, no such factorization is generically available. Because the observable outcomes are obtained through the projection Π , the probability distribution accessible at the effective level is given by

$$P(a, b \mid A, B) = \sum_{\omega \in \Pi^{-1}(a, b)} \mu(\omega), \quad (3)$$

where μ is a probability measure on Ω , and $\Pi^{-1}(a, b)$ denotes the set of underlying configurations compatible with the joint observable outcome (a, b) .

When Π is non-injective, the preimage $\Pi^{-1}(a, b)$ does not decompose into independent subsets associated with A and B . The same underlying configuration $\omega \in \Omega$ may therefore contribute simultaneously to the preimages of several observable outcome pairs, preventing the introduction of response functions $A(A, \omega)$ and $B(B, \omega)$ whose joint statistics reproduce $P(a, b \mid A, B)$ through a factorizable form. As a result, the joint probability $P(a, b \mid A, B)$ does not admit a representation as a product of marginal probabilities conditioned on any set of effective variables. The failure of factorization arises from the structure of the projection itself, not from any dynamical interaction between the measurement regions.

Importantly, locality at the underlying level is preserved. The measure $\mu(\omega)$ may be defined over configurations with strictly local causal structure, and no superluminal

influence or signal exchange is required. The violation of Bell inequalities therefore reflects a mismatch between the factorizable structure assumed in Bell-type derivations and the actual structure of effective descriptions induced by non-injective mappings.

This observation identifies non-injectivity as a sufficient condition for the failure of Bell factorization. Bell inequalities constrain only those effective models in which the mapping from underlying configurations to observables is injective or admits an equivalent factorizable representation. When this condition fails, Bell-type correlations may arise without violating local causality at the underlying level.

Non-injectivity as a saturation effect

The non-injective character of the projection $\Pi : \Omega \rightarrow \mathcal{O}$ considered throughout this work should not be interpreted as an abstract or ad hoc assumption. In physically relevant realizations, non-injectivity arises naturally when the effective description $\mathcal{O}$ reaches a structural saturation, in the sense that it cannot encode all relational constraints present at the level of the underlying configuration space Ω .

In such regimes, multiple distinct configurations $\omega \in \Omega$ become indistinguishable within the effective description, leading to an objective loss of injectivity of the projection. This loss is structural rather than epistemic: it reflects a limitation of the effective representation itself, not an incomplete specification of underlying variables.

The resulting multiplicity of pre-images $\Pi^{-1}(o)$ for a given observable outcome $o \in \mathcal{O}$ naturally defines a structural entropy associated with the projection,

$$S_{\Pi} \equiv - \sum_{o \in \mathcal{O}} \nu(o) \log \nu(o), \quad \nu(o) = \mu(\Pi^{-1}(o)),$$

where μ denotes the measure on Ω induced by the underlying dynamics. This *projection entropy* quantifies the degree of non-injectivity of the effective description and is independent of any notion of epistemic ignorance.

Within this perspective, the breakdown of probabilistic factorization derived in the present work can be understood as the minimal informational manifestation of such a saturation mechanism. Violations of Bell-type inequalities correspond to the weakest regime in which projection-induced non-injectivity becomes operationally observable, without invoking nonlocal dynamics, retrocausal influences, or hidden-variable completions. Bell-type correlations may therefore be interpreted as the minimal observable signature of a non-zero projection entropy S_{Π} .

3. Bell Inequalities Revisited: Structural vs Dynamical Assumptions

Bell's theorem is commonly presented as a no-go result for local realist theories. More precisely, it establishes that no model satisfying a specific set of probabilistic assumptions can reproduce all quantum correlations. It is therefore essential to distinguish carefully between the assumptions entering the derivation of Bell inequalities and the physical principles they are often taken to represent.

The derivation of Bell inequalities relies on three key assumptions. First, outcome probabilities are assumed to be well-defined and conditioned on a complete specification of relevant variables. Second, joint probabilities are assumed to factorize for spacelike separated measurements, reflecting the absence of direct causal influence between distant measurement settings. Third, the conditioning variables are assumed to be statistically independent of the measurement choices. Violations of Bell inequalities imply that at least one of these assumptions fails.

In many discussions, the failure of Bell inequalities is interpreted as evidence for a breakdown of locality [2]. However, locality in Bell's sense is a condition on the factor-

ization of effective probabilities, not a direct statement about the causal structure of the underlying theory. Bell inequalities constrain models in which observable outcomes can be represented as functions of local settings and a shared set of variables that fully determine those outcomes. They do not directly constrain the existence or absence of superluminal interactions.

Within the framework considered here, the failure of Bell inequalities originates from the breakdown of effective factorization. As shown in the previous section, non-injective mappings between underlying configurations and observable outcomes generically prevent the construction of a complete set of outcome-defining variables at the effective level. Although the underlying description may be local and deterministic, the observable description does not admit a factorized probabilistic representation.

This distinction clarifies the sense in which Bell's theorem applies. Bell inequalities are valid only for effective descriptions in which observable outcomes can be parameterized by a set of variables that renders the projection from underlying configurations injective or equivalently factorizable. When this condition is not met, the assumptions required for the derivation of Bell inequalities are violated independently of any consideration of causal nonlocality.

From this perspective, violations of Bell inequalities do not compel the introduction of nonlocal dynamics or retrocausal mechanisms. They instead signal a structural limitation of effective descriptions in which observable outcomes are treated as independently specifiable local properties. Nonlocal correlations arise because joint outcomes must be globally consistent with a single non-factorizable effective description, not because information propagates between distant regions.

The present analysis therefore reframes Bell's theorem as a constraint on a class of descriptive models rather than as a direct statement about the ontology or dynamics of physical reality. Bell inequalities test the compatibility of observed correlations with injective and factorizable effective descriptions. When non-injective projections are involved, Bell-type correlations may arise while preserving locality at the underlying level.

4. Measurement, Decoherence, and the Emergence of Classicality

The structural origin of Bell-type correlations identified above naturally raises the question of their apparent absence in classical macroscopic phenomena. Everyday physical systems exhibit effectively local and statistically independent behavior, despite being ultimately composed of quantum constituents. Any satisfactory account of Bell violations must therefore explain not only their existence, but also their suppression in the classical limit.

Within the present framework, this transition is understood as a change in the effective properties of the projection from underlying configurations to observable descriptions. While the projection is generally non-injective at microscopic scales, environmental interactions, coarse-graining, and limited observational resolution progressively reduce the number of distinct underlying configurations compatible with a given observable outcome. As a result, the effective mapping becomes approximately injective.

Decoherence plays a central role in this process. Through continuous interaction with uncontrolled environmental degrees of freedom, interference between distinct underlying configurations is dynamically suppressed. From the perspective of observable descriptions, this suppression eliminates the global consistency constraints responsible for non-factorizable joint probabilities. Observable outcomes can then be treated as effectively independent, restoring the factorization required for classical statistical reasoning.

In this regime, joint probabilities admit an approximate decomposition of the form

$$P(a, b \mid A, B) \approx P(a \mid A) P(b \mid B), \quad (4)$$

up to corrections that are exponentially small in the strength of environmental coupling or the degree of coarse-graining. Bell inequalities are therefore not violated in practice, not because the underlying structure has changed, but because the effective description no longer retains access to non-injective correlations.

Importantly, this recovery of classical behavior does not require the introduction of additional collapse postulates or modifications of quantum dynamics. It follows from the same structural mechanism responsible for Bell violations, applied in a regime where the projection becomes effectively one-to-one. Classicality thus corresponds to a limit in which observable descriptions admit an approximately complete specification, rendering joint probabilities effectively factorizable.

From this viewpoint, the quantum-to-classical transition reflects a change in descriptive accessibility rather than a change in fundamental physical laws. Bell-type correlations are suppressed when the information loss associated with non-injective projection is masked by decoherence and coarse-graining. The classical world emerges as a regime in which effective injectivity is restored, and with it, the validity of classical notions of separability and locality.

5. Discussion and Conceptual Positioning

The analysis presented in this work proposes a structural reinterpretation of Bell inequality violations that avoids introducing nonlocal dynamics, hidden variables, or modifications of quantum mechanics. It is therefore important to clarify how this approach relates to existing interpretations and foundational proposals addressing quantum nonlocality.

Unlike local hidden-variable models, the present framework does not assume the existence of a set of accessible variables that fully determine observable outcomes [3]. No completion of the quantum state is postulated, and no additional degrees of freedom are introduced. The failure of Bell inequalities arises not from incomplete knowledge of underlying variables, but from the non-injective nature of the mapping between underlying configurations and observable descriptions.

The present approach is also distinct from superdeterministic models [4]. While superdeterminism denies statistical independence between measurement settings and underlying variables, no such assumption is required here. Measurement choices remain free and uncorrelated with the underlying configuration space. Bell violations arise solely from the structural properties of effective descriptions, not from conspiratorial correlations between settings and states.

Retrocausal interpretations similarly invoke influences propagating backward in time to account for nonlocal correlations. By contrast, the mechanism discussed here is entirely atemporal at the descriptive level. No causal influence, forward or backward, is required between distant measurement events. Correlations emerge from the global consistency constraints imposed by non-factorizable effective descriptions, rather than from dynamical signaling.

The present framework is compatible with standard accounts of quantum contextuality, but shifts the emphasis from contextual measurement dependence to descriptive non-injectivity. Rather than attributing Bell violations to context-dependent properties of observables, we identify a more general structural origin: the impossibility of assigning independent local outcomes within a single effective description when the underlying mapping is many-to-one.

Finally, we stress that the present work does not advocate a specific ontological interpretation of quantum mechanics. It neither endorses nor rejects realism, operationalism, or informational approaches. Our aim is more modest: to isolate a minimal and sufficient structural condition under which Bell-type inequalities fail. Non-injective projection provides such a condition, clarifying how quantum correlations can arise without abandoning locality at the underlying level.

In physical realizations, this non-injectivity can be understood as a consequence of finite descriptive resolution. In particular, Planck's constant h sets a fundamental bound on the distinguishability of underlying configurations, thereby controlling the effective size of the equivalence classes $[\omega]$ that define observable outcomes.

In this sense, Bell inequality violations may be viewed not as evidence for exotic dynamics, but as indicators of intrinsic limitations of effective descriptions [5]. They reveal the boundaries of applicability of classical probabilistic reasoning, rather than the presence of nonlocal causal mechanisms.

6. Discussion and Conceptual Positioning

6.1. Relation to local hidden-variable models

Violations of Bell inequalities are commonly interpreted as ruling out local hidden-variable models. More precisely, Bell's theorem constrains a class of effective descriptions in which measurement outcomes are assumed to be determined by a set of underlying variables that renders joint probabilities factorizable for spacelike separated measurements.

The analysis presented here clarifies that Bell inequalities do not directly constrain underlying physical dynamics. They constrain the logical structure of effective probabilistic descriptions. When observable outcomes admit an injective or effectively factorizable representation in terms of underlying variables, Bell-type inequalities apply. When this condition fails, Bell-type correlations may arise even if the underlying description is local, deterministic, and causally well behaved.

Within the framework considered here, the failure of Bell inequalities originates from the non-injective nature of the mapping between underlying configurations and observable outcomes. Because multiple underlying configurations correspond to the same effective description, no set of outcome-determining variables exists at the observable level that would allow joint probabilities to be decomposed into independent local contributions. Bell inequalities are therefore violated not because of nonlocal dynamics, but because the assumptions required for probabilistic factorization are not satisfied by the effective description itself.

6.2. Non-injective projection versus superdeterminism and free choice

A frequent objection to any violation of statistical independence in Bell-type analyses is that it implicitly relies on superdeterministic assumptions, namely correlations between measurement settings and underlying physical states. In such scenarios, the apparent violation of Bell inequalities is attributed to a conspiratorial coordination between experimental choices and microscopic conditions.

The mechanism discussed here is fundamentally different. No correlation is postulated between measurement settings and underlying configurations, and no restriction is imposed on the freedom of experimental choices at the level of observable descriptions. Measurement settings are assumed to be freely and independently chosen within the effective description, in full accordance with standard experimental practice.

The loss of statistical independence arises instead from the non-injective structure of the mapping from underlying configurations to observable outcomes. Because distinct underlying configurations are identified at the effective level, conditioning on observable

variables does not isolate independent subsystems. The resulting failure of probabilistic factorization is therefore structural and geometric in origin, rather than causal or conspiratorial.

In this sense, the present framework preserves operational free choice while violating the assumptions required for Bell-type factorizations. The breakdown of statistical independence reflects intrinsic limitations of effective descriptions, not a fine-tuned coordination of initial conditions.

6.3. Measurement, contextuality, and effective descriptions

The structural origin of Bell-type correlations identified above naturally raises the question of their suppression in classical macroscopic regimes. Everyday physical systems exhibit effectively local and statistically independent behavior, despite being composed of quantum constituents.

Recent work in quantum foundations has emphasized that nonlocal and contextual correlations may be understood as obstructions to constructing globally consistent probabilistic models from local measurement contexts [6]. Within ontological-model frameworks, observable statistics are likewise interpreted as coarse-grained descriptions of an underlying ontic state space [7]. The mechanism discussed here is complementary in spirit, but identifies a more primitive structural origin for the failure of Bell factorizability: the non-injective mapping between underlying configurations and observable descriptions.

Within the present framework, this transition is understood as a change in the effective properties of the descriptive mapping. Environmental interactions, decoherence, and coarse-graining progressively reduce the number of distinct underlying configurations compatible with a given observable outcome. As a result, the effective mapping becomes approximately injective, and joint probabilities recover an approximately factorizable form.

In this regime, observable outcomes may be treated as effectively independent, and Bell inequalities are no longer violated in practice. Classical statistical independence thus emerges as a limiting case of effective injectivity, rather than as a fundamental principle.

The present work does not propose a modification of quantum mechanics or a new ontological framework. Its contribution is to isolate a minimal and sufficient structural condition for the failure of Bell inequalities, thereby clarifying the conceptual origin of quantum correlations while preserving both operational locality and empirical adequacy.

We conclude that Bell inequality violations need not be interpreted as evidence for fundamental nonlocality, but may instead reflect intrinsic limitations of effective descriptions in which observable outcomes are treated as independently specifiable local properties.

6.4. Conclusion

In conclusion, we have shown that violations of Bell inequalities do not require dynamical nonlocality, nor the abandonment of realism, but can instead be understood as a generic consequence of non-injective projection. Within this framework, Bell-type correlations arise not from superluminal influences or hidden causal mechanisms, but from structural features of effective descriptions in which multiple underlying configurations correspond to the same observable outcomes.

This analysis is purely structural and does not rely on any modification of quantum dynamics or on the introduction of additional hidden variables. The failure of Bell-type factorizability is traced to the descriptive level itself, and reflects the impossibility of assigning independent local outcomes within a single effective representation when the underlying mapping is non-injective.

This perspective is naturally embedded in relational approaches in which spacetime and observables are not taken as fundamental, but emerge as effective descriptions from an

underlying configuration space. In particular, the non-injective projection considered here arises generically in relational and spectral frameworks where spacetime geometry itself is reconstructed from more primitive relational structures [1].

Quantum correlations then cease to appear as instances of mysterious “action at a distance” and instead reflect global consistency constraints imposed by the non-injective mapping between underlying configurations—possibly of infra-physical or pre-geometric nature—and the domain of localized measurements.

From this viewpoint, the empirical success of relativistic locality and quantum statistics is preserved at the effective level, while their apparent tension is resolved by recognizing the intrinsic limitations of projected descriptions. Classical locality and probabilistic independence emerge as limiting cases in which the effective mapping becomes approximately injective, restoring factorizability without altering the underlying relational structure. Bell-type correlations may therefore be interpreted as the minimal observable signature of a non-zero projection entropy S_{Π} associated with the non-injective character of the effective description.

Appendices

Appendix A Formal Conditions for the Failure of Probabilistic Factorization

This appendix provides a formal clarification of the structural conditions under which probabilistic factorization fails in the presence of non-injective projections. The purpose is not to introduce new physical assumptions, but to make explicit the logical content underlying the arguments presented in the main text.

Let (Ω, Σ, μ) be a probability space describing underlying configurations $\omega \in \Omega$, equipped with a normalized measure μ . Observable outcomes are obtained through a measurable mapping

$$\Pi : \Omega \rightarrow \mathcal{O}, \quad (\text{A5})$$

where $\mathcal{O}$ denotes the space of observable descriptions. We assume that Π is non-injective, so that there exist distinct $\omega_1 \neq \omega_2$ such that $\Pi(\omega_1) = \Pi(\omega_2)$.

Let A and B denote two spacelike separated measurement settings, and let $a \in \mathcal{O}_A$ and $b \in \mathcal{O}_B$ denote the corresponding observable outcomes. The joint probability distribution accessible at the effective level is given by

$$P(a, b \mid A, B) = \mu\left(\Pi^{-1}(a, b)\right) = \sum_{\omega \in \Pi^{-1}(a, b)} \mu(\omega). \quad (\text{A6})$$

Suppose that a factorizable representation of the joint distribution exists. Then there must exist a measurable variable λ and a probability density $\rho(\lambda)$ such that

$$P(a, b \mid A, B) = \int d\lambda \rho(\lambda) P(a \mid A, \lambda) P(b \mid B, \lambda). \quad (\text{A7})$$

This representation implicitly assumes that λ provides a complete and non-redundant parameterization of the relevant underlying configurations for the observable outcomes.

However, when Π is non-injective, no such variable λ can generically exist at the effective level. Any candidate λ constructed from observable data must identify entire equivalence classes

$$[\omega] = \{\omega' \in \Omega \mid \Pi(\omega') = \Pi(\omega)\}, \quad (\text{A8})$$

rather than individual underlying configurations. As a result, conditioning on λ does not isolate independent contributions associated with A and B .

More formally, if λ is a function of $\Pi(\omega)$, then λ is constant over each equivalence class $[\omega]$. The joint probability conditioned on λ therefore takes the form

$$P(a, b \mid A, B, \lambda) = \sum_{\omega \in [\omega_\lambda]} \mu(\omega \mid \lambda), \quad (\text{A9})$$

which does not decompose into a product of independent marginal terms unless additional constraints are imposed. In generic non-injective cases, such constraints are absent, and factorization fails.

This establishes that non-injectivity of the mapping from underlying configurations to observable descriptions is sufficient to obstruct any representation of the form Eq. (A7). The failure of Bell-type factorization thus follows from a purely structural property of the descriptive mapping, independently of any assumptions about dynamical nonlocality, retrocausality, or hidden variables.

The result emphasizes that Bell inequalities apply only to effective descriptions admitting an injective or equivalently factorizable representation. When observable outcomes

arise through non-injective projections, violations of Bell inequalities are a natural and generic consequence of the descriptive structure itself.

Appendix B A Toy Model Illustrating Non-Injective Projection

We present a simple toy model intended to illustrate how Bell-type correlations may arise from non-injective projection without invoking nonlocal dynamics, hidden variables, or superdeterministic assumptions. The model is deliberately minimal and does not aim to reproduce the full structure of quantum theory. Its purpose is solely to make explicit the logical mechanism underlying the failure of probabilistic factorization.

Appendix B.1 Underlying configuration space

Let Ω denote a finite set of underlying configurations. Each configuration $\omega \in \Omega$ represents a complete specification of a relational structure. No spatiotemporal interpretation is assumed at this level, and no notion of subsystem decomposition is imposed.

We consider a situation in which two measurement regions, denoted A and B , are identified only at the level of observable descriptions. At the level of Ω , the configurations need not decompose into independent components associated with A and B .

Appendix B.2 Non-injective projection

Observable outcomes are defined through a projection

$$\Pi : \Omega \rightarrow O_A \times O_B,$$

where O_A and O_B denote the sets of possible outcomes for measurements performed in regions A and B , respectively.

The projection Π is assumed to be non-injective. Distinct underlying configurations may therefore correspond to the same pair of observable outcomes (a, b) . Observable states are thus identified with equivalence classes

$$[\omega] = \{\omega' \in \Omega \mid \Pi(\omega') = \Pi(\omega)\}.$$

Appendix B.3 Emergence of correlations

Let $\mu(\omega)$ be a probability distribution defined on Ω . The joint probability distribution accessible at the observable level is given by

$$P(a, b) = \sum_{\omega \in \Pi^{-1}(a, b)} \mu(\omega).$$

Because the preimage $\Pi^{-1}(a, b)$ does not generically decompose into independent subsets associated with A and B , the joint probability $P(a, b)$ does not admit a factorized representation of the form $P(a)P(b)$ or $P(a \mid \lambda)P(b \mid \lambda)$ for any effective variable λ .

The resulting correlations arise not from any interaction or information exchange between A and B , but from the fact that both outcomes are constrained by the same underlying relational configuration. From the perspective of the effective description, the two outcomes appear correlated even when the corresponding measurements are spacelike separated.

Appendix B.4 Free choice and absence of superdeterminism

Measurement settings at A and B may be freely and independently chosen within the effective description. The probability distribution $\mu(\omega)$ is assumed to be independent of

these choices. No correlation between measurement settings and underlying configurations is required or assumed.

The violation of statistical independence arises solely from the non-injective nature of the projection Π . Because observable outcomes do not provide access to the full underlying configuration, conditioning on observable variables does not isolate independent degrees of freedom. The failure of probabilistic factorization is therefore structural rather than conspiratorial.

Appendix B.5 Explicit CHSH violation from non-injective projection.

We make the Bell–CHSH violation explicit by exhibiting an observable probability model generated by a non-injective projected description.

Let measurement settings be $x \in \{0, 1\}$ at A and $y \in \{0, 1\}$ at B , and outcomes be $a, b \in \{-1, +1\}$. Consider the no-signalling correlations defined by

$$P(a, b|x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2} & \text{if } ab = (-1)^{xy}, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (\text{A10})$$

Equivalently, for each setting pair (x, y) , the outcomes are perfectly correlated when $xy = 0$ and perfectly anti-correlated when $xy = 1$, while each marginal is uniform: $P(a|x) = P(b|y) = 1/2$.

The correlators are therefore

$$E_{xy} \equiv \sum_{a,b=\pm 1} ab P(a, b|x, y) = (-1)^{xy}, \quad (\text{A11})$$

and the CHSH expression is

$$S \equiv |E_{00} + E_{01} + E_{10} - E_{11}| = |1 + 1 + 1 - (-1)| = 4 > 2. \quad (\text{A12})$$

This violates the Bell–CHSH bound while preserving operational no-signalling.

Realization as a projected description. Define an underlying finite configuration space $\Omega \equiv \{(a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1) \mid a_x, b_y \in \{-1, +1\}\}$ equipped with a normalized measure μ supported only on the subset satisfying the global constraint

$$a_0 b_0 = a_0 b_1 = a_1 b_0 = +1, \quad a_1 b_1 = -1. \quad (\text{A13})$$

Such a constraint is admissible here because Ω is not assumed to factorize into independent subsystem state spaces at the underlying level (Appendix B.1–B.3). Observable pairs are obtained through a context-dependent projection

$$\Pi_{x,y} : \Omega \rightarrow O_A \times O_B, \quad \Pi_{x,y}(a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1) = (a_x, b_y). \quad (\text{A14})$$

The dependence of the projection on the measurement settings does not introduce contextual hidden variables. It merely reflects that different experimental settings select different components of the same underlying configuration ω , analogously to reading different coordinates of a fixed vector. Since many distinct underlying quadruples map to the same observable pair (a, b) for fixed (x, y) , the map $\Pi_{x,y}$ is generally non-injective. The observable probabilities are then exactly of the projected form

$$P(a, b|x, y) = \mu(\Pi_{x,y}^{-1}(a, b)), \quad (\text{A15})$$

and, for a symmetric choice of μ on the constrained subset Eq. (A13), reproduce Eq. (A10).

This explicit construction illustrates the logical point emphasized throughout: Bell–CHSH violations may arise because the effective observable description is generated by a non-injective projection from an underlying configuration space that does not admit a subsystem factorization compatible with Bell-type probabilistic assumptions. No superluminal influence is invoked at the level of underlying configurations; the violation reflects the structural mismatch between factorizable effective models and projected descriptions with irreducible global constraints.

Appendix B.6 Interpretation

This toy model illustrates how two observables may appear correlated because they represent different projections of a single underlying structure. In this sense, Bell-type correlations may be understood as consistency constraints imposed by a non-factorizable effective description, rather than as signatures of nonlocal causation.

While highly simplified, the model captures the essential logical mechanism discussed in the main text. More elaborate realizations may be constructed by enriching the structure of Ω or the projection Π , but the origin of the correlations remains the same: the non-injective mapping between underlying configurations and observable outcomes.

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